

LittleReads

The Day I Became a Young Scientist

Science

Ages 8–10

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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Published by LittleReads Publishing

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With a focus on the development of the scientific method, the course will provide a hands-on experience in the laboratory. Students will learn to ask a question, form a hypothesis, test it, and report your findings."

Chapter 1: The Question

Faridah sat in the garden that evening, thinking.

"What question do I want to answer?" she asked herself.

She looked at the plants in her mother's garden. Some grew big and strong. Others were small and weak, even though they were planted at the same time.

"Why do some plants grow better than others?"

She wrote down her question: "Does the type of soil affect how fast plants grow?"

Now she needed a hypothesis — an educated guess.

"I think," she wrote, "that plants growing in compost soil will grow faster than plants in regular soil, because compost has more nutrients."

There. Her hypothesis was written. Now she needed to test it.

Chapter 2: The Experiment

Faridah collected six small pots. She put compost soil in three and regular garden soil in three.

She planted the same type of seeds — beans — in each pot, making sure they were the same depth.

She placed all six pots in the same sunny spot and gave them the same amount of water every day.

"The only difference," she told herself, "is the soil. Everything else stays the same. That is called a controlled experiment."

Every day after school, Faridah measured each plant. She used a ruler to check height and counted the leaves.

She wrote everything in a notebook, just like a real scientist.

Chapter 3: The Results

After three weeks, the results were clear.

The plants in compost soil were taller, greener, and had more leaves than the ones in regular soil.

Faridah calculated the averages:

Compost soil: average height 14 cm, average 6 leaves

Regular soil: average height 9 cm, average 4 leaves

"My hypothesis was correct!" she said. "Plants in compost soil grow faster because compost has more nutrients."

But she was not done. Good scientists also think about what else might have affected the results.

"Maybe I should repeat the experiment," she wrote. "To make sure my results are reliable."

Chapter 4: The Presentation

On science project day, Faridah presented her experiment to the class.

She explained her question, her hypothesis, her method, her results, and her conclusion.

Then she said something that surprised everyone:

"I learned that being a scientist is not about being the smartest person in the room. It is about being the most curious. Anyone can be a scientist if they ask questions, test their ideas, and keep learning."

The class clapped. Mr. Osei smiled.

"Faridah, you did not just do a science project. You did real science. That is what makes a true scientist."

Chapter 5: A New Way of Thinking

After her project, Faridah saw the world differently.

When her mother said, "The soup tastes better today," Faridah asked, "What did you change in the recipe?"

When it rained one day and was sunny the next, she thought about weather patterns.

When her brother said, "I always lose at football," she said, "Have you tried practising differently? Maybe you need to test a new strategy."

Science was not just a school subject. It was a way of thinking — of observing the world, asking questions, and finding answers through evidence.

And that is how Faridah became a young scientist. Not because of a project, but because of a curious mind.

What We Learned

- The scientific method has steps: question, hypothesise, experiment, analyse, conclude.
- A controlled experiment changes only one variable at a time.
- Recording data carefully is essential for good science.
- Being a scientist means being curious and asking "why?"

Discussion Questions

1. What question would you like to investigate?
2. Why did Faridah only change one thing in her experiment?
3. How can you use scientific thinking in your daily life?

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Thank you for reading!

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